The antecedent threshold for five-variable Gaussian conditional-independence inference

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Abstract

For an elementary Gaussian conditional-independence Horn implication on five labels, call a rule four-local if it is a semantic consequence of requiring every marginal and conditional four-variable face to be regular-Gaussian realizable. Let a_5 be the least number of distinct antecedents in a premise-minimal valid rule with full five-label support that is not four-local. We prove

$$a_5 = 4.$$

The upper bound is supplied by the five-variable instance of Šimeček's implication,

$$[12 \mid 3] \wedge [13 \mid 4] \wedge [14 \mid 5] \wedge [15 \mid 2] \Longrightarrow [12],$$

together with an explicit 80-atom model of the complete marginal and conditional four-variable theory that violates the conclusion. For the lower bound, all three-antecedent sets are classified under label permutations and duality. Proper-support cases are reduced analytically, while the full-support cases are settled by rational Krawczyk certificates that provide positive-definite Gaussian counterexamples for every conclusion not forced by the four-local theory. A deterministic standard-library verifier rebuilds the finite catalogues and orbit reductions and checks the countermodel, interval certificates, and coverage conditions.

1 Introduction

For a regular Gaussian vector, an elementary conditional-independence statement $X_i \perp X_j \mid X_K$ is equivalent to the vanishing of an almost-principal minor of its covariance matrix. A Horn implication among such statements asks whether one minor must vanish whenever a specified collection of other minors vanishes throughout the positive-definite cone. This formulation connects Gaussian conditional independence with polynomial relations and finite implication systems [8].

The gaussoid axioms give universal local rules for these implications. They characterize regular-Gaussian structures on three labels, but on four labels additional relations are needed. Lněnička and Matúš classified the four-variable case: of the 679 four-gaussoids, 629 are regular-Gaussian realizable, separated by five further implication schemes [7]. No finite collection of bounded-variable rules characterizes Gaussian conditional independence in all dimensions [11, 10].

Here the complexity of an implication is measured by its number of distinct antecedents. Boege proved that every regular-Gaussian inference form with at most two antecedents follows from the gaussoid axioms [2, 1]. The next question is finite: on five labels, how many antecedents are needed for a valid elementary Horn implication that cannot be recovered from the complete four-variable theory?

Let T_4 denote the theory obtained by requiring all five marginal and all five conditional four-variable faces to belong to the 629-element regular-Gaussian catalogue. Define a_5 as the least number of antecedents in a premise-minimal valid rule with full five-label support that is not a semantic consequence of T_4. The main result is

$$\boxed{a_5 = 4}.$$

The upper bound uses the five-variable instance of Šimeček's implication and a direct correlation proof. An explicit 80-bit T_4 model satisfies its four premises and violates its conclusion, so the rule is genuinely beyond four-local inference. For the lower bound, all three-antecedent sets are reduced under permutations and duality. Proper-support representatives are treated by a positive-definite extension argument; full-support representatives are settled by rational interval certificates that cover every conclusion outside the iterated T_4 closure.

The result concerns elementary singleton-conclusion Horn implications for regular positive-definite Gaussians. It does not classify all four-antecedent rules or all five-variable Gaussian CI structures. Sections 2–6 define the problem and prove the two bounds. Section 7 describes the verifier, Section 8 places the threshold in the literature, and the appendices record the data conventions and reproduction commands.

2 Gaussian CI structures and the four-local theory

2.1 Elementary atoms and almost-principal minors

Let N be a finite label set and let $X = (X_i)_{i\in N}$ be centered Gaussian with positive-definite covariance matrix Σ. For distinct $i, j \in N$ and $K \subseteq N \setminus \{i, j\}$, write

$$[ij \mid K] \quad \text{for} \quad X_i \perp X_j \mid X_K,$$

and abbreviate $[ij \mid \varnothing]$ by $[ij]$. The elementary atom $[ij \mid K]$ is equivalent to

$$\mathrm{ap}_{ij|K}(\Sigma) := \det \Sigma_{\{i\}\cup K,\,\{j\}\cup K} = 0. \tag{1}$$

The order of rows and columns in (1) affects only a fixed sign and never the zero condition. The set of elementary atoms on N is denoted by $\mathcal{A}_N$. It has

$$|\mathcal{A}_N| = \binom{n}{2} 2^{n-2};$$

for $n = 5$ this is 80.

A *regular-Gaussian CI structure* is the set of elementary atoms whose almost-principal minors vanish for some $\Sigma \succ 0$. Positive diagonal rescaling preserves all these zero patterns, so Σ may be normalized to a correlation matrix $R = (r_{ij})$. For a singleton conditioning set,

$$[ij \mid k] \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad r_{ij} - r_{ik}r_{jk} = 0. \tag{2}$$

A *gaussoid* is an elementary CI structure satisfying the four standard gaussoid axiom schemes [8, 7, 4]. Every regular-Gaussian structure is a gaussoid, but the converse fails. This distinction is essential: the finite countermodel in Section 5 is an abstract gaussoid with realizable four-faces, not a claimed five-variable Gaussian realization.

2.2 Marginal and conditional four-faces

Fix $N = \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$. For $x \in N$, deleting x gives the *marginal four-face*

$$\{[ij \mid K] : i, j \neq x,\ K \subseteq N \setminus \{i, j, x\}\}.$$

The *conditional four-face at x* is obtained by restricting to atoms that condition throughout on x and then removing x from the displayed conditioning sets:

$$[ij \mid K] \longleftrightarrow [ij \mid K \cup \{x\}], \qquad i, j \neq x.$$

A regular Gaussian remains regular Gaussian after marginalization or conditioning, so every such face is a realizable four-variable structure.

The four-variable catalogue contains 679 gaussoids and exactly 629 regular-Gaussian structures [7]; denote the latter set by $T_4^{(4)}$. The verifier constructs the elementary gaussoid axioms as a 24-variable CNF, enumerates all 679 models with a deterministic DPLL procedure, and then retains the 629 models satisfying the five additional Lněnička–Matúš implication schemes. Published catalogue digests are cross-checks, not input data.

Definition 2.1 (The four-local theory T_4)**.** A five-label elementary CI structure is a model of T_4 if each of its ten marginal and conditional four-faces belongs to $T_4^{(4)}$. A Horn implication is a semantic consequence of T_4 if it holds in every such 80-bit model.

The computation also uses a constructive closure. For each face, retain the members of $T_4^{(4)}$ containing the current face premises and adjoin every atom common to them; repeat over the ten faces to a fixed point. Each added atom holds in every compatible four-variable model, so the procedure is sound for Definition 2.1. Section 6 proves that every Gaussian-valid conclusion with three antecedents belongs to this closure. By contrast, a single global 80-bit model of Definition 2.1 refutes semantic consequence and hence every such derivation.

Every five-variable gaussoid-axiom instance is contained in one of these faces. It has three distinguished labels and a background conditioning set L. If $|L| \leq 1$, an unused label can be omitted; if $|L| = 2$, conditioning the entire face on either member of L contains the instance. Thus every T_4 model is itself a gaussoid.

2.3 Support, premise minimality, and the threshold

For $a = [ij \mid K]$, set $\mathrm{supp}(a) = \{i, j\} \cup K$. For a rule $P \Rightarrow c$, its support is the union of the supports of its premises and conclusion.

Definition 2.2 (Genuine five-variable rule and a_5)**.** A Horn implication $P \Rightarrow c$ on five labels is *genuinely five-variable beyond* T_4 if:

1. it is valid for every regular five-dimensional Gaussian vector;
2. its support is all five labels; and
3. it is not a semantic consequence of T_4.

It is *premise-minimal* if no proper subset of P validly implies c. Define a_5 as the minimum $|P|$ over premise-minimal genuinely five-variable rules.

The identity covariance satisfies every elementary CI atom, so positive-premise sets are never vacuous. Distinct antecedents are counted once; repeating an atom does not change $|P|$.

3 The threshold theorem

Theorem 3.1 (Antecedent threshold)**.** *Four antecedents are necessary and sufficient for a genuinely five-variable elementary regular-Gaussian CI Horn implication beyond* T_4*. Equivalently,*

$$\boxed{a_5 = 4}.$$

The theorem follows from the next two propositions.

Proposition 3.2 (Four-antecedent upper bound)**.** *The implication*

$$[12 \mid 3] \wedge [13 \mid 4] \wedge [14 \mid 5] \wedge [15 \mid 2] \quad \Longrightarrow \quad [12] \tag{3}$$

is regular-Gaussian valid, has support all five labels, and is not a consequence of T_4*.*

Proposition 3.3 (Three-premise lower bound)**.** *Every regular-Gaussian-valid elementary Horn implication on five labels with at most three distinct antecedents is a consequence of* T_4*, or has support on at most four labels and hence is not genuinely five-variable beyond* T_4*.*

Proposition 3.2 gives $a_5 \leq 4$. Proposition 3.3 gives $a_5 \geq 4$. Section 5 and Corollary 5.2 additionally prove that no premise in (3) can be deleted, satisfying the premise-minimality clause of Definition 2.2.

4 The four-antecedent upper bound

Šimeček's Theorem 3.2 states a forbidden-minor result; the Gaussian part of its proof yields the regular-Gaussian implication family used here [11]. Its five-variable member is (3). The following direct calculation proves the Gaussian-validity part of Proposition 3.2.

Set

$$a = r_{12}, \quad b = r_{13}, \quad c = r_{14}, \quad d = r_{15}, \qquad p = r_{23}, \quad q = r_{34}, \quad u = r_{45}, \quad s = r_{25}.$$

By (2), the four premises in (3) are

$$f_1 = a - bp = 0, \qquad f_2 = b - cq = 0, \qquad f_3 = c - du = 0, \qquad f_4 = d - as = 0.$$

They satisfy the polynomial identity

$$f_1 + pf_2 + pqf_3 + pquf_4 = a(1 - pqus). \tag{4}$$

Since every 2×2 principal correlation submatrix is positive definite,

$$|p|, |q|, |u|, |s| < 1.$$

The second factor on the right of (4) is therefore positive. Under the four premises its left side vanishes, so $a = r_{12} = 0$. This proves the implication without division by a correlation.

The same telescoping calculation gives the general regular-Gaussian implication in Šimeček's argument. For distinct labels $0, 1, \ldots, k$, with $k \geq 3$,

$$[01 \mid 2] \wedge [02 \mid 3] \wedge \cdots \wedge [0, k-1 \mid k] \wedge [0k \mid 1] \quad \Longrightarrow \quad [01]. \tag{5}$$

Write $a_j = r_{0j}$, $p_j = r_{j,j+1}$ for $1 \leq j < k$, and $p_k = r_{1k}$. The premises give

$$a_j - a_{j+1}p_j = 0 \quad (1 \leq j < k), \qquad a_k - a_1 p_k = 0.$$

After multiplying the jth equation by $p_1 \cdots p_{j-1}$ and summing, one obtains

$$a_1\big(1 - p_1 p_2 \cdots p_k\big) = 0.$$

Positive definiteness gives $|p_j| < 1$ for every j, hence $a_1 = 0$. This notation has $k = n - 1$ relative to Šimeček's J_n. The case $k = 3$ is also rule (20) of Lněnička and Matúš [7]; the case $k = 4$ gives Proposition 3.2.

5 Nonlocality and premise minimality

Analytic validity does not show that a rule escapes four-variable inference. That claim is certified by a finite countermodel.

Proposition 5.1 (T_4 nonlocality)**.** *There exists an 80-bit model of all ten T_4 face constraints that contains the four premises of* (3) *and omits* [12]*. Hence* (3) *is not a semantic consequence of T_4.*

Proof. Appendix A defines the bit order and prints the complete bitstring. The verifier performs four checks.

1. Bits $1, 10, 20, 25$, corresponding to [12 | 3], [13 | 4], [14 | 5], and [15 | 2], are one; bit 0, corresponding to [12], is zero.
2. Every instance of the four elementary gaussoid axiom schemes is evaluated directly on all ordered triples and background conditioning sets.
3. For each omitted label, the 24 marginal bits are extracted in canonical four-atom order and matched against the 629-element catalogue.
4. The same is done for the 24 atoms conditioning throughout on that label.

All ten masks belong to $T_4^{(4)}$. The bitstring is therefore a global model of Definition 2.1 and a countermodel to the implication. □

The countermodel is not asserted to be five-variable Gaussian-realizable; indeed validity of (3) rules that out. Its role is purely proof-theoretic: it separates the complete four-face model class from regular-Gaussian inference.

Corollary 5.2 (Premise minimality)**.** *The four antecedents in* (3) *are premise-minimal.*

Proof. The full premise set does not force [12] in T_4. By monotonicity, no three-premise subset forces [12] in T_4 either. Proposition 3.3 says that any Gaussian-valid implication with at most three antecedents must be T_4-local unless it lacks full support; the four deletion rules have full rule support. Therefore every deletion is Gaussian-invalid. The verifier also checks that all four deletions canonicalize to premise orbit $(1, 10, 20)$ and that certificate 272 covers the four mapped conclusions $0, 8, 16, 24$. □

6 The three-antecedent lower bound

For Proposition 3.3, the layer with three antecedents is finite, and the cases with fewer antecedents follow from Boege's two-antecedental completeness theorem. Proper-support premise sets are handled analytically; full-support sets require certified Gaussian counterexamples.

6.1 Finite enumeration and symmetry reduction

There are $\binom{80}{3} = 82{,}160$ sets of three distinct atoms. We quotient them by

$$G = S_5 \times \langle * \rangle, \qquad [ij \mid K]^* = [ij \mid N \setminus (K \cup \{i, j\})].$$

Label permutations plainly preserve Gaussian validity and T_4. For a positive-definite covariance matrix, inversion realizes duality on its CI structure. This follows from Jacobi's complementary-minor identity

$$\det\big((\Sigma^{-1})_{I,J}\big) = \pm \frac{\det(\Sigma_{J^c,I^c})}{\det \Sigma},$$

applied to the almost-principal minors. Duality also exchanges marginal and conditional four-faces, while inversion preserves the 629-element four-variable catalogue. Thus both Gaussian validity and semantic T_4 consequence are invariant under the 240 atom maps in G.

The enumeration selects one lexicographically canonical representative P from each premise orbit. For fixed P, conclusions are further quotiented by the stabilizer G_P. If $P \Rightarrow c$ is invalid or T_4-local, applying any $g \in G$ gives the same alternative for $gP \Rightarrow gc$; no rule is lost by these two orbit reductions.

Premise support is not invariant under duality, because a previously absent label can enter a conditioning set. The terms *proper support* and *full support* in Table 1 therefore refer to the selected representative, not to the whole orbit. There are 105 mixed-support orbits. This does not affect the reduction: the validity-or-locality conclusion established at a representative transfers to every member of its orbit.

Table 1: Three-antecedent classification counts.

Stage	Count	Meaning
Labelled antecedent triples	82,160	All $\binom{80}{3}$ distinct three-atom sets
Premise orbits	439	Orbits under S_5 and duality
Canonical representatives with proper support	104	Representative premise support has at most four labels
Canonical representatives with full support	335	Representative premise support is all five labels
Mixed-support premise orbits	105	Orbit contains both proper- and full-support triples
Rule orbits in the 335-representative stratum	21,357	Conclusion orbits under each representative stabilizer
Forced by iterated T_4 closure	190	Sound four-local derivations
Nonlocal rule orbits	21,167	Require Gaussian counterexamples
Rational interval certificates	364	One per full-support representative, plus 29 second branches

The 439 representatives split into 104 proper-support and 335 full-support cases. Lemma 6.1 below disposes of the proper-support cases. For each full-support representative P, the verifier computes the fixed point $C(P)$ of the constructive T_4 closure from Section 2. Membership $c \in C(P)$ gives a sound four-local derivation of $P \Rightarrow c$.

It remains to rule out Gaussian validity for conclusions outside $C(P)$. After quotienting conclusions by G_P, the 335 representatives give 21,357 rule orbits. Of these, 190 lie in the computed closure and 21,167 do not. Each remaining orbit is assigned a rational interval certificate for a positive-definite correlation matrix satisfying P and violating a representative conclusion. The group action then supplies counterexamples for every rule in that orbit.

For each P, a certificate carries a set of conclusion atoms whose almost-principal minors are certified nonzero at its Gaussian root. The verifier requires the union of these cover sets to be exactly

$$\mathcal{A}_5 \setminus C(P).$$

This equality is the exhaustiveness condition: every possible conclusion is either derived by the four-local closure or refuted by a regular-Gaussian model. It is checked separately for all 335 full-support representatives. The verifier also reconstructs all 439 premise orbits, including the 105 mixed-support orbits.

6.2 Gaussian witness systems

A correlation matrix on five labels has ten off-diagonal coordinates, ordered by pairs

$$(12), (13), (14), (15), (23), (24), (25), (34), (35), (45).$$

For a premise triple $P = (p_1, p_2, p_3)$, the discovery program chooses three coordinates $y = (y_1, y_2, y_3)$ as unknowns and fixes the remaining seven to rational numbers. It forms

$$F(y) = \big(\mathrm{ap}_{p_1}(R(y)), \mathrm{ap}_{p_2}(R(y)), \mathrm{ap}_{p_3}(R(y))\big).$$

A numerical root is used only to propose a box. The accepted proof data consist of a rational box $X = X_1 \times X_2 \times X_3$, rational fixed coordinates, and a rational nonsingular preconditioner C. Polynomial and Jacobian interval evaluations use fraction arithmetic with outward endpoint formulas, so theorem acceptance contains no floating-point tolerance.

For midpoint $x \in X$ and an interval enclosure $F'(X)$ of the Jacobian, define the Krawczyk operator [6, 9]

$$K(x, X) = x - CF(x) + \big(I - CF'(X)\big)(X - x). \tag{6}$$

The strict componentwise inclusion

$$K(x, X) \subset \mathrm{int}(X) \tag{7}$$

with nonsingular C satisfies the standard Krawczyk existence-and-uniqueness criterion [6, 9]: F has exactly one real zero in X. Only existence is needed for the implication classification; uniqueness records the stronger certified conclusion.

At that root, positive definiteness is certified by interval Sylvester tests. The determinant of every leading principal block of the full interval matrix has a strictly positive lower endpoint. For every conclusion index in the certificate's `covers` list, interval evaluation of its almost-principal minor excludes zero. Therefore the root is an actual regular-Gaussian counterexample to every covered conclusion.

One premise triple can have disconnected or algebraically distinct solution branches. A single witness need not refute all nonforced conclusions. Twenty-nine canonical full-support representatives require a second certified box; the union of the two cover sets is used. This explains why 335 representatives require 364 rather than 335 certificates.

6.3 Worked certificate

Certificate 272 treats the canonical premises

$$[12 \mid 3], \qquad [13 \mid 4], \qquad [14 \mid 5]$$

and is also the premise-minimality witness orbit from Corollary 5.2. Its unknown coordinates are r_{12}, r_{13}, r_{14}. The other seven correlations are fixed rational numbers. Table 2 gives decimal renderings for readability; the verifier reads the numerator–denominator pairs in the JSON file.

Table 2: Readable summary of rational certificate 272. All displayed acceptance margins are lower bounds derived from rational intervals.

Quantity	Certified interval or lower bound	Role
r_{12}	$[0.000286218259399,\ 0.000286418259399]$	conclusion [12] is false
r_{13}	$[-0.00536186144355,\ -0.00536166144355]$	unknown root coordinate
r_{14}	$[-0.0329011047999,\ -0.0329009047999]$	unknown root coordinate
Krawczyk interior margin	$\geq 9.99 \times 10^{-8}$ in each coordinate	strict inclusion
$\det R_{1:2,1:2}$	> 0.9999999179	Sylvester positivity
$\det R_{1:3,1:3}$	> 0.9971197683	Sylvester positivity
$\det R_{1:4,1:4}$	> 0.9462868919	Sylvester positivity
$\det R$	> 0.7549461182	full positive definiteness

The fixed correlations, in pair order $(15), (23), (24), (25), (34), (35), (45)$, are approximately

$$(-0.231821, -0.053400, 0.144036, -0.179468, 0.162966, -0.256434, 0.141924).$$

The certificate record gives the rational box, all seven fractions, the 3×3 rational matrix C, and 77 covered nonforced atoms.

6.4 Proper-support extension lemma

The finite certificate enumeration is needed only when the premises collectively use all five labels.

Lemma 6.1 (Generic positive-definite extension)**.** *Let P be any finite set of elementary CI atoms supported on a proper subset $S \subsetneq N$. If a proposed conclusion c uses a label outside S, then there is a positive-definite rational covariance matrix satisfying every atom in P and violating c. One matrix may be chosen to violate any prescribed finite collection of such conclusions simultaneously.*

Proof. Set the principal covariance block on S equal to the identity. Then every atom supported on S, in particular every premise, holds. Extend to all labels with

$$\Sigma = I + E,$$

where the $S \times S$ block of E is zero and only covariances involving labels outside S may vary. For sufficiently small E, for example $\|E\|_2 < 1$, all eigenvalues of $I + E$ are positive. The old principal block is unchanged, so all premises remain true.

The almost-principal minor $g_c(E)$ for a conclusion involving an outside label is a polynomial in the new entries, and it is not identically zero. If an endpoint of c lies outside S, set only the direct covariance between the two endpoints to a nonzero parameter t and leave conditioned labels independent. Then $g_c(E) = \pm t$. If both endpoints lie in S and an outside label x appears only in the conditioning set, correlate x with both endpoints by parameters u, v and leave all other new entries zero. The Schur-complement cross term is $-uv$, so $g_c(E)$ is nonzero for suitable u, v.

Thus each unwanted conclusion defines a proper algebraic subset of an open neighborhood of $E = 0$. A finite union of proper real algebraic subsets cannot fill that neighborhood. Rational points are dense, so a sufficiently small rational E avoids all of them while preserving positive definiteness and every premise. □

If both premises and conclusion lie in S, any regular Gaussian on S extends independently to five labels. Conversely, embed S in a four-label marginal face, adding unused labels when $|S| < 4$. A valid implication on S holds in every regular-Gaussian structure in the complete four-variable catalogue and hence in that face of every T_4 model. It is therefore T_4-local. Lemma 6.1 disposes of every conclusion outside S. Thus each of the 104 canonical proper-support representatives is invalid or T_4-local, and the invariance argument above transfers that alternative to its entire orbit, including the 105 mixed-support orbits.

6.5 Zero, one, and two antecedents

Boege's two-antecedental completeness theorem states that every inference form with at most two antecedents that is valid for regular Gaussians on any finite ground set follows from the gaussoid axioms [2, 1]. Horn implications are a special case. This includes zero antecedents; directly, no elementary atom is universally valid, since a correlation matrix with only $r_{ij} = r_{ji} = 1/2$ nonzero off the diagonal violates $[ij \mid K]$ for every admissible K. As observed after Definition 2.1, each five-variable gaussoid-axiom instance lies in a marginal or conditional four-face. Hence every valid rule with at most two antecedents is a semantic consequence of T_4.

Combining the low-antecedent theorem, the representative reduction with Lemma 6.1, and the 335-representative rational certificate exhaustion proves Proposition 3.3, and with Proposition 3.2 proves Theorem 3.1.

7 Verification

Numerical searches were used to propose implications and witness boxes. They do not enter the acceptance conditions summarized in Table 3.

The standalone three-antecedent verifier imports no discovery module and uses only the Python standard library. It reconstructs the atoms, group maps, four-variable catalogue, face closures, rational determinant intervals, Krawczyk images, and conclusion covers. The upper-bound verifier separately checks the polynomial identity, the 80-bit countermodel, all gaussoid-axiom instances, and the ten face memberships.

Two scholarly obligations remain outside the finite computation: the published classification theorem identifying the 629 filtered structures with the regular-Gaussian four-variable structures, and the mathematical proofs of the five Lněnička–Matúš schemes. The code independently enumerates the 679 gaussoids and checks the stated finite consequence after a separately reviewable transcription of the axioms and schemes; it does not formalize the source proofs.

Table 3: Claim-to-certificate map.

Claim	Proof object / verifier	Arithmetic domain
$\lvert\mathcal{A}_5\rvert = 80$, symmetry order 240	atom reconstruction in `verify_m3_classification.py`	finite integer combinatorics
$T_4^{(4)}$ has 629 models	axiom-to-CNF construction and deterministic DPLL in `independent/catalogue.py`; LM filters in `independent/verify_t4.py`	finite bit logic
Upper-bound validity	sparse identity in `verify_cycle_rule.py`	integer polynomials
Upper-bound nonlocality	80-bit countermodel and ten face masks	finite bit logic
Three-antecedent exhaustion	439 premise orbits; 105 mixed-support; 21,357 rule orbits in the certified stratum	finite group action
Gaussian counterexamples	364 records in `m3_interval_certificates.json`	exact rational intervals
Positive definiteness	five leading-principal determinant enclosures (the 1×1 block is the unit diagonal)	exact rational intervals
Conclusion nonvanishing	almost-principal determinant enclosures	exact rational intervals
Premise minimality	four deletion mappings to certificate 272	finite symmetry plus intervals
Package integrity	`MANIFEST.sha256`, `verify_manifest.py`	SHA-256

8 Related work

Matúš formulated Gaussian conditional independence through polynomial relations among covariance minors [8]. Lněnička and Matúš subsequently classified the four-variable regular-Gaussian structures and gave the five additional implication schemes used here to reconstruct $T_4^{(4)}$ [7].

Šimeček's Theorem 3.2 constructs, for every $n \geq 4$, a shared-endpoint family of independence models that is not Gaussian representable [11]. In the regular-Gaussian case, the proof yields (5); the $k = 4$ instance is (3). The general family is therefore prior work. The present argument adds the T_4 countermodel, premise minimality, and the exhaustive three-antecedent lower bound for its five-variable member.

Sullivant established non-finite characterization by a distinct cyclic family [10]. Its premise endpoints form a cycle, whereas the premises in (5) share one endpoint; their endpoint graphs have different degree sequences and are not related by relabelling. Sullivant's proof uses binomial primary decomposition and excludes components from the positive-definite cone by Hadamard-product arguments, while (4) gives a direct proof for the family needed here.

Boege proved two-antecedental completeness of the gaussoid axioms, with a later correction, and introduced self-adhesivity as a stronger necessary approximation to Gaussian realizability [2, 1, 3]. Related work on the geometry and construction of gaussoids further distinguishes abstract gaussoid structure from positive-definite Gaussian realizability [4, 5].

No prior result establishing the five-variable antecedent threshold $a_5 = 4$ was located in the reviewed literature. This bounded literature search does not by itself establish priority, and specialist review remains appropriate.

9 Discussion and open problems

Theorem 3.1 determines the least antecedent count but not the full set of four-antecedent rules beyond T_4. Several related problems remain.

1. A classification of premise-minimal four-antecedent rules remains open.
2. A structural proof of the three-antecedent lower bound could replace or compress the 364-certificate exhaustion.
3. For $n > 5$, one can define the threshold a_n relative to the complete $(n-1)$-local face theory. Šimeček's family supplies possible upper bounds, but nonlocality and lower bounds must be proved separately.

4. The rational interval verification has not been formalized in a proof assistant. A separate implementation would provide an additional check.

The classification in this paper is limited to elementary CI atoms, singleton-conclusion Horn implications, regular positive-definite Gaussians, five labels, and at most three antecedents in the lower-bound search. It does not cover singular Gaussians, disjunctive conclusions, or general semigraphoids.

10 Reproducibility

From the repository root, the mathematical verification is run by

```
make verify-core
```

The target is deterministic, uses only the Python standard library, and has no network dependency. Its acceptance checks use finite combinatorics, integer polynomial identities, and rational interval arithmetic. The three-antecedent verifier does not import the numerical discovery code; it reconstructs the atoms, group action, four-variable catalogue, closures, Krawczyk images, and coverage conditions. Appendix E records the component commands and expected output.

Acknowledgment of generative-AI assistance

Generative-AI systems were used in an iterative agentic research workflow for literature search and source triage, computational implementation, candidate generation, numerical exploration, adversarial checking, and manuscript drafting and revision. Model output was not treated as mathematical evidence: the claims retained in the final manuscript are supported by the analytic arguments and executable exact certificates described above. The author directed the workflow, reviewed the relevant sources and claims, and takes responsibility for the final content.

A Canonical atom order and countermodel

The 80 atoms are ordered deterministically. Iterate unordered endpoint pairs (i, j) lexicographically. For each pair, list the remaining labels increasingly as (u_0, u_1, u_2) and iterate masks $m = 0, \ldots, 7$; bit t of m includes u_t in K. Thus indices $0, 1, 2, 3$ begin

$$[12],\ [12 \mid 3],\ [12 \mid 4],\ [12 \mid 34],$$

and the same mask convention continues through pair $(4, 5)$. This rule uniquely determines every index without relying on a prose table.

The nonlocality countermodel is

```
01000000001000000000101001000000000000000000000000001001001011000000000000000000
```

where one means membership in the abstract CI structure. Its SHA-256 and all source hashes are pinned in the release manifest.

B Construction of the four-variable catalogue

The independent builder first orders the 24 elementary CI atoms, translates every elementary gaussoid-axiom instance into CNF, and enumerates every satisfying assignment by deterministic unit propagation and branching. It obtains 679 distinct models. Their canonical digest agrees with the published four-gaussoid list, but no catalogue file is read. The builder then evaluates, under every permutation of four labels, the five additional implication schemes numbered (17)–(21) by Lněnička and Matúš [7]. Exactly 50 models violate at least one scheme; the 629 retained one-membership masks have the independently pinned digest used by both principal verifiers.

A face map is a tuple of 24 indices into the five-label 80-atom order. For omitted label x, the marginal map leaves all conditioning sets unchanged; the conditional map unions $\{x\}$ into every conditioning set. Ten such maps are reconstructed separately in both principal verifiers.

C Certificate schema and worked data

Each record in `m3_interval_certificates.json` contains:

- `premise_indices`: three canonical atom indices;
- `fixed`: seven edge indices mapped to exact numerator–denominator pairs;
- `unknown`: three distinct edge indices;
- `boxes`: rational lower and upper endpoints for each unknown;
- `C`: a nonsingular 3×3 rational Krawczyk preconditioner;
- `covers`: conclusion indices whose interval minors exclude zero.

The verifier requires the fixed and unknown coordinate sets to partition all ten off-diagonal entries. It recomputes determinant and derivative enclosures by signed permutation expansion; the matrices are small enough for this dependency-free calculation.

For certificate 272 the first rational unknown box is

$$\left[\frac{1036593930957}{3621690430000000}, \frac{1037318269043}{3621690430000000}\right],$$

which excludes zero and therefore directly refutes [12]. The remaining fractions and preconditioner are retained in the machine-readable certificate rather than typeset as several lines of large integers.

D Verifier pseudocode and coverage logic

The verifier's acceptance condition can be summarized as

```
assert sha256(T4) == pinned_hash
assert rebuild_T4(all_679_gaussoids) == published_629
assert |S5 x duality| == 240
assert premise_orbits == 439
assert canonical_support_strata == (104 proper, 335 full)
assert mixed_support_orbits == 105
for certificate z:
    assert coordinates_partition_10_edges(z)
    assert det(C_z) != 0
    assert K_z(midpoint, box) is strictly inside box
    assert every leading principal determinant interval is positive
    assert every covered conclusion interval excludes zero
for canonical full-support premise representative P:
    assert union(covers(P)) == all_atoms minus T4_closure(P)
assert rule_orbit_counts == (21357 total, 190 local, 21167 nonlocal)
assert all four cycle-premise deletions map to certified coverage
```

A witness is allowed to cover many conclusions, and two witnesses for one premise may cover complementary branches. No claim requires all nonforced conclusions to fail in one Gaussian matrix.

E Reproducibility commands and expected output

From the archive root:

```
python3 independent/verify_t4.py
python3 independent/verify_m3_classification.py
python3 independent/verify_cycle_rule.py
python3 independent/verify_corruptions.py
python3 tools/verify_manifest.py
make verify-core
```

The expected principal lines are:

```
independent_T4_ok G4=679 T4=629 excluded=50
m3_classification_ok premise_orbits=439 canonical_full_support=335
  mixed_support_orbits=105 rule_orbits=21357 nonlocal=21167 certificates=364
  second_branches=29 T4=629 cycle_deletions=4
cycle_rule_ok identity=exact gaussoid_axioms=ok t4_faces=10
  premise=[1,10,20,25] conclusion=0
corruption_checks_ok cases=4
manifest_ok entries=[package-specific count]
```

The bracketed manifest count is generated from the final archive and is not part of the mathematical theorem.

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